had not had time to read the thesis carefully.

Bryce DeWitt, Wheeler's colleague, fellow quantum cosmologist, and co-organizer of the Chapel Hill quantum gravity conference, was skeptical of Everett's thesis at first. "I am afraid that it is precisely at the most crucial point in Everett's argument where many people, including myself, will be unable to swallow your implication.… What I am *not* prepared to accept" is the branching of worlds required by Everett's theory, wrote DeWitt to Wheeler. "I can testify to this from personal introspection, as can you. I simply do *not* branch." Wheeler passed DeWitt's reply on to Everett; in his reply, Everett drew an analogy between DeWitt's objection and early objections to the Copernican Sun-centered model of the solar system, tinged with his usual irony:

> One of the basic criticisms leveled against the Copernican theory was that "the mobility of the earth as a real physical fact is incompatible with the common sense interpretation of nature." In other words, as any fool can plainly see the earth doesn't *really* move because we don't experience any motion. However, a theory which involves the motion of the earth is not difficult to swallow if it is a complete enough theory that one can also deduce that no motion will be felt by the earth's inhabitants (as was possible with Newtonian physics). Thus, in order to decide whether or not a theory contradicts our experience, it is necessary to see what the theory itself predicts our experience will be.
>
> Now in your letter you say, "… I simply do *not* branch." I can't resist asking: Do you feel the motion of the earth?

DeWitt, amazed, could only laugh and say "touché." He was fully convinced—and for the time being, Everett's sole disciple.

Everett, finally armed with his PhD, continued to work at WSEG and other parts of the Cold War military-industrial complex for the rest of his life, never returning to academia. It's tempting to conclude that he left academia because of his poor treatment at the hands of Wheeler and Bohr's circle, but the reality is that Everett never wanted to be an academic. He had planned to leave academia long before Wheeler's disastrous visit to